
Data centers

From pgswood <pgswood@ktis.net>

Date Mon 2026-05-25 9:08 AM

To Curt Warfield <cwarfield@callawaycounty.org>

Dear Commissioner Mr. Warfield,

I am a resident of Mokane Mo and I am writing to formally express my opposition to the proposed data center project in Callaway County.

While I support economic development, I believe AI data centers and similar business projects present significant risks to our community that must be properly mitigated.

*****A large data center can actually use as 3 times as much power as the Callaway Plant produces. Even a small plant using half the Callaway Plant's production is not sustainable, not for us or the country as a whole. Electric rates won't only rise, there will be places taking blackouts. With another coal plant coming down when it's license is up, which is happening as early as 2031. Our power grid is already in jeopardy. This cannot be made up with solar. To put this in perspective it would take 11,500 acres of solar panels to replace the amount of power Callaway produces. So these company's saying they'll use solar to offset their massive power usage is not feasible. Then if you read the water table issues that other areas have had, this becomes quite scary.*****

My concerns include:

1. Environmental Impact: The potential for excessive water consumption and noise pollution from cooling systems and generators.
2. Grid Reliability: The immense energy demands could cause utility rates to rise for local residents.
3. Land Use: This project does not align with the rural/residential character of our area, disrupting agricultural land and local wildlife.

While these facilities provide tax revenue, they are intense industrial users that require careful regulation to be "good neighbors". At a minimum, please consider the following when evaluating new proposals:

- * Mandating noise mitigation: Restricting chiller operations to meet noise limits at property lines.
- * Environmental Protection: Prohibiting projects in floodplains or areas with high water tables, and regulating water and electric usage such that it does not impact the availability or costs of these basic utilities for the citizens of the surrounding communities.
- * Thermal Pollution Study: Evaluating the impact of "heat domes" on surrounding agriculture.

At minimum, I urge the commission to institute a moratorium to conduct a comprehensive impact study before approving any such project.

Sincerely,
Patti Wood
Mokane Mo